



▲ FROST-COVERED TREES IN THE CARPATHIAN MOUNTAIN FORESTS

Kalkalpen National Park

Location The Northern Limestone Alps, northern Austria

More than 80 percent of this protected park is forest. Cloaking hills, ridges, and valleys on limestone, this is central Europe’s largest continuous tract of forest. Within the forest are several enclaves of virgin spruce, fir, and beech forest, thought not to have been cleared since the end of the last ice age. Larger areas are now being left unmanaged, so dead wood is left to rot—providing habitats for many invertebrates and woodpeckers. Almost 1,000

species of plant have been recorded. Lynx, brown bear, and endangered bats inhabit the region.

Carpathian Mountain Forests

Location The Carpathian Mountains, western Ukraine and eastern Slovakia

Ten areas of primeval beech forest along a 115-mile (185-km) stretch of the Carpathians were designated a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 2007 for the quality of the woodland and their biodiversity. About 70 percent of the 300 square miles (780 square km) of forest, which includes oak and hornbeam

in addition to beech, is in Ukraine, the remainder in Slovakia. The site includes old-growth and virgin forest and supports 64 species of mammals, including brown bear, lynx, wolf, and wild boar.

The Ardennes

Location The Ardennes Mountains of Belgium, Luxembourg, Germany, and France

This upland region comprises a landscape of ridges up to 2,277 ft (694 m) above sea level and steep-sided valleys on sandstone, quartzite, slate, and limestone bedrock. At least

half of its area is covered by forest, with a rich mix of oak, beech, ash, hazel, maple, aspen, spruce, and pine. Generally scarce bird species—such as hazel grouse, hawfinch, Tengmalm’s owl, black and gray-headed woodpeckers, and nutcrackers—breed in the forest.

Mediterranean Evergreen Forest

Location The Mediterranean Basin, including Spain, southern France, Italy, Greece, Morocco, Tunisia, and Algeria

This broadleaf evergreen forest, which is transitional between Mediterranean pine forest and